Ekta Yatra (Unity Journey) in December 1991–January 1992, to hoist the tricolour in Srinagar's Lal Chowk.

Exactly as the BJP argued in 2019, the Jan Sangh, in the 1950s, blamed the resistance in Kashmir on its ruling party elites. 'The ruling circles of Kashmir are interested in perpetuating the discrimination because it pays them. They try to perpetuate their hold over the Government through rigged elections and authoritarian methods. What is worse, the wrath of the people against the authorities in Kashmir (who have developed a vested interest in this position and who defend it in the name of internal Autonomy of the State) is in the ultimate, diverted against the Government and the people of India.' This is why it asked for 'immediate steps' to 'delete the transitional article 370' and to bring Kashmir in line with 'other States of India without any further delay'.[87]

Again, in 1966, the CWC reiterated its demands, arguing that Article 370 was a big hindrance to integration because it had 'created a psychological barrier' between Kashmiris and other Indians. In the Jan Sangh's view, Article 370 was 'exploited by anti-national elements and Pak agents to the detriment of vital Indian interests'.[88]

This is the historical legacy Prime Minister Modi and Amit Shah have delivered as an article of faith.

Jan Sangh and Its Target of Congress-mukt Bharat in the 1950s

In early 2014, Narendra Modi issued his now-famous call for a Congress-mukt Bharat (Congress-free India). The roots of this idea too can be traced back to Mookerjee's inaugural address to his party. Speaking to party delegates in their 1951 meeting, Mookerjee said that he saw the Jan Sangh emerging as the main Opposition party for all those who had a 'deep-rooted discontent and frustration' with the Congress. Instead of trying to solve their grievances, he argued, the Nehru government was trying to 'gag all those who sought to ventilate the people's grievances'. 'The Congress has lost the support of the people and was therefore attempting to perpetuate its rule by stifling all opposition. The drift today towards dictatorship was